# ALI ABOLGHASEMI

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## EDUCATION

- **HEC Montréal** **2022**
  PhD in Finance
- **Concordia University** **2015**
  MA in Economics
- **University of Tehran** **2006**
  BA in Economics

## REFERENCES

**Prof. Christian Dorion**
HEC Montréal
+1 514 340-1522
christian.dorion@hec.ca

**Prof. Alexandre Jeanneret**
UNSW Business School
+61 451-482-723
a.jeanneret@unsw.edu.au

## WORKING PAPERS

**2020** **Granular Gravity: Equity-Bond Returns & Correlation** , Job Market Paper

I find strong empirical evidence that the correlation between firms bond and equity returns increases significantly when the distribution of firms in the economy becomes more granular than atomistic. Data supports the hypothesis that this arises from granularity being a priced factor in the cross-sections of both equity and bond returns. I construct a theoretical framework in which risk inherent in very large firms grows systematic. This granular channel brings about two predictions validated by the data: First, bond and equity returns comove in the same direction with respect to granularity shocks. Second, this co-movement is due to a mutually and similarly priced factor in the cross section of equity and bond returns.

PRESENTED AT HEC Montréal Finance Seminars (March 2021), HEC Montréal PhD Brownbags (March 2020), Global Finance Conference (May 2021), Society of Financial Econometrics Summer School* (July 2021), World Finance Conference * (August 2021), Southern Finance Conference (Nov 2021)*

**2019** **Equity Prices in a Granular Economy**, with Harjoat Bhamra, Christian Dorion & Alexandre Jeanneret

This paper revisits the properties of the conditional CAPM when the economy is granular. When some firms are more like "grains" than atoms, shocks to such firms are not diversified away. When a large firm becomes larger, the economy becomes more granular, as the large firm represents a greater share of the market. This increase in granularity translates into a higher cross-sectional difference in equity betas, which reduces the slope of the Security Market Line (SML). We provide empirical support for the negative relation between the slope of the SML and various granularity measures from the U.S. equity market. When granularity decreases, portfolio betas are strongly and positively related to average equity returns. In contrast, the relation turns negative when granularity increases, thereby explaining the relatively "flat" SML observed unconditionally.

PRESENTED AT Northern Finance Association (Sep 2020), Université Laval (Feb 2020), HEC-McGill Winter Workshop (March 2020)

## TEACHING

**2021** Lecturer, *Futures and Options (BA)*, HEC Montréal

**2021** Teaching Assistant, *MSc Course: Derivatives Pricing*, HEC Montréal

* Scheduled for presentation

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|---|---|---|
| **2020** | Teaching Assistant, *MSc Course: Market Risk Management* , McGill University |
| **2018** | Teaching Assistant, *MSc Courses: Financial Econometrics, Corporate Finance*, HEC Montréal |
| **2011-2013** | Part-time Lecturer, *Investment Analysis by COMFAR III Expert*, Undergraduate Course in Economics, University of Tehran |

## SCHOLARSHIPS & AWARDS

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|---|---|
| **2020-21** | **SSRCH Doctoral Fellowship**. 20,000 CAD<br>*By Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council* |
| **2020** | Travel Grant . 750 USD<br>*By American Finance Association* |
| **2019** | Pierre Arbour PhD Scholarship . 17,000 CAD<br>*By Pierre Arbour Foundation* |
| **2019** | Hydro Québec PhD Scholarship . 20,000 CAD<br>*By Hydro Québec* |
| **2018** | Jean-Louis Mercier PhD Scholarship . 6,000 CAD<br>*By Jean-L. Mercier* |
| **2016-20** | PhD Entrance Scholarship. 80,000 CAD<br>*By HEC Montréal* |
| **2015** | Graduation Excellence Award. 2,000 CAD<br>*By Concordia University* |

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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|---|---|
| **July 2021** | Society of Financial Econometrics (SoFiE) Summer School<br>Kellogg School of business. Chicago, Illinois, USA (Virtual) |
| **July 2019** | Society of Financial Econometrics (SoFiE) Summer School<br>Kellogg School of business. Chicago, Illinois, USA. |
| **2018** | Academic Writing Workshop<br>HEC Montréal |
| **2018** | CEAR-RSI Household Finance Workshop<br>Hotel Saint Sulpice. Montréal, Canada. |

## OTHER

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| Languages | English (Fluent), French (B2), Arabic (Fluent), Persian (Native). |
| SoftSkills | MATLAB†, SAS‡, R† |
| Certificate | CFA Level I passed, *June 2015* |

†Proficient
‡Data cleaning and/or panel data analysis